



**MFC
YOUTH**

HOUSEHOLD SERVANTS TRAINING I

manual

Missionary Families of Christ – Youth Committed Circle Household Servants Training



Rationale

The basic unit of MFC Youth is the household. It is through the household that members get to share their struggles and victories in an intimate way. It is where they feel more loved and supported. Therefore, it is important for our community to have equipped household servants who can effectively lead their members.

General Objective

The activity aims to provide the new MFC Youth household servants the knowledge and understanding of leading and managing a household group.

Specific Objectives

At the end of the weekend, the participants will be able to:

1. Understand what a household is and its importance to the community
2. Learn the proper attitudes and characteristics in leading the household
3. Know the consideration of discerning a household topic and the steps in creating one; and
4. Experience leading a household and apply their learning's to their actual household

Target Participants

MFC Youth members who have:

- Finished the Basic Pastoral Formation Track of MFC Youth
- Facilitated or will facilitate a discussion group in the youth camp

Program Description

This Household Servants Training is given as a whole-day activity, preferably in a parish/church, chapel, or in any venue that can accommodate the target number of participants and is conducive to group discussions, workshops and processing talks. This one-day activity covers two pastoral talks and two workshops.

The Household Servants Training is to be organized by the Chapter Servant together with the Chapter Couple Coordinator right after a Youth Camp (to allow ample time for preparation for the

youth camp). It is important to note that since this is a whole-day activity, there may be a need to prepare snacks or meals for the participants.

Suggested Schedule

TIME	ACTIVITY
08:30-09:00	Registration/Gathering
09:00-09:15	Worship
09:15-09:30	Emcee/ Short Game
09:30-10:15	Session 1: Household Basics
10:15-10:30	Break
10:30-11:15	Workshop 1: Discerning a Household Topic
11:15-12:00	Activity: Household Topic Writing
12:00-01:00	Lunch
01:00-01:15	Short game
01:15-01:45	Workshop 2: Leading a Household Meeting
01:45-02:30	Activity: Mock Household
02:30-02:45	Break
02:45-03:15	Leading Worship Workshop
03:15-03:45	Activity: Exhortation
03:50-04:30	Session 2: Heart of the Household Servant
04:30-05:00	Praisefest with Commitment Ceremony

Service Team Needed

- Team Leader (Unit Servant)
- Registration Team (They are in-charge of making sign-up sheets and name tags. They are also in-charge of the registration table.)
- Facilitators
- Music Team (may be just one person)

- Worship leader and Praisefest leader
- 4 Speakers
- Prayer Warriors
- Materials
 - Guitar / Musical instruments
 - Song sheets
 - MFC Youth JUMPSTART Manual
 - MFC Youth HST Manual
 - Bible
 - Holy Rosary

Note:

- 1. If possible, no participant is allowed to be a member of the registration team or music team so they will have full attention on the sessions and workshops. If this is not possible, the team leader should make sure that they listen and participate to the activities and talks as soon as their duty is finished.*
- 2. Non-participants should also be assigned as prayer warriors for the whole duration of the event.*
- 3. It is very important that every participant brings a notebook, pen and a Bible in the HST.*

Missionary Families of Christ – Youth Committed Circle Household Servants Training



Session 1: Household Basics

Rationale

This is the first talk of the Household Servants Training. This session explains what a household is and why it is very important in our community.

Specific Objectives

At the end of the session, the participants will be able to:

1. Have a specific and clear understanding about what a household is;
2. Understand the importance of the household; and
3. Know the ideal structure of an MFC Youth household.

Speaker's Profile

- A brother or sister who has been a household servant for at least two years and has basic understanding of what a household is

Methodology

- | | |
|---------------------------------|--------------|
| ▪ Talk proper | 40 - 45 mins |
| ▪ Reflection and closing prayer | 05 mins |

Expanded Outline

I. Introduction

After a youth finishes his/her youth camp, the next step is to put him/her in a small cell group called **household**. His/her life as a member of MFC Youth will most likely start within that group, providing him/her spiritual support and a sense of belongingness. Placing him/her in a group with youth about his/her age allows him/her to open his/her life with other people who have same interests and who will most likely help him/her grow as a person of values and faith.

II. The Household Defined

Since it is where the members are formed spiritually to grow into maturity, it is important that we understand what a household really is.

A. On a technical level, the Household is:

1. The basic unit in the MFC Youth community
2. Finalized right after the member finishes the Youth Camp
3. A cell group composed of approximately 5 brothers or 5 sisters led by a male household servant and female household servant respectively.
 - a. The task of the male household servant is to pastor/ guide the brothers while the female household servant's main task is to pastor/ guide the sisters.
 - b. They work by leading the group and act as an older brother and as an older sister.
 - c. For Unit Households and up, it is the brother who should ultimately lead the whole group (This will empower him in preparation for his current and future roles in the family).
4. It is grouped according to gender, location and age of the members (if possible).
5. It serves as a support group for spiritual nourishment and brings a sense of belonging for the members.

Note: In an extreme case of a lack of household servants, the number of members per household may temporarily double up.

B. The Household meetings are:

1. Small prayer meetings that consist of topics and sharing's about God's words and messages.
2. Held regularly twice a month, and lasts for about 2-3 hours per meeting.
3. Ideally done in a house-to-house basis (Household venue changes from one member's house to another). This provides opportunities to come into worship as a group and for

other family members to see that their child/children is/are being supported and is/are spiritually being nourished. This is possible if there is a couple coordinator in that particular household level (e.g. the chapter/unit couple coordinator for the lower household of the MFC YOUTH chapter youth servant's).

- However, in cases where there is no couple coordinator in the particular household level, households can be done in a collective basis in a chapter assembly. This is during the third week when the chapter gathers in one venue for worship and breaks out into households after a session.
- In the cases of the Campus based and High School based programs, household meetings can be done within the school premises during club/organization assemblies, break times or after classes

Note: Please also refer to the High School or Campus Based primer.

- a. When it is done in a setting wherein the groups of the brothers and the sisters gather together at a common time and venue and then come into worship, the brothers need to separate from the sisters during the discussion/ sharing part.
- b. It is ideal that the group of the brothers and the group of the sisters conduct separate households, with a different time, date or venue

C. On a personal and spiritual level, the household is

1. A place for personal and spiritual growth through:

- God's words (Luke 11:28)
 - i. The household members are nourished from the message of God through the topics that are being discussed in household meetings, e.g. chosen topic from the household track or a discerned topic by the household servant
 - ii. God's word is the main focus in every household meeting. Everyone has the opportunity to hear God's word and learn from the group.

- Prayers
 - i. Each meeting starts and ends with worship. Members are encouraged to pray and to praise the Lord, resulting to prayer becoming their habit (cf. Colossians 4:2).
 - ii. Everyone is also encouraged to pray for one another, thus allowing them to learn the value of accountability towards one another. This further gives a feeling of assurance that they are being cared for and supported (cf. Colossians 4:3).
 - iii. Note: In cases where household meetings are held in public places (ex: Coffee Shops, Restaurants), the household must start and end with a prayer
- Sharing personal experiences and God's messages
 - i. In every household meeting, the household servant gives opportunities for everyone to share and hear one others' sharing. This builds a comfortable environment for every member to express himself/herself more and easily share the things he/she is going through, his/her innermost feelings and most importantly what God is telling him/her.
 - ii. Sharing one's experiences and God's messages to the members of the household also blesses and affirms those who hear it (cf. Luke 11:8).
 - iii. There is no room for judgments in a household; personal things that are shared should be kept within the household (cf. Proverbs 24:23).

2. A System of Caring – The book of Proverbs tells us that a friend loves you all the time and a brother helps in times of trouble (cf. Proverbs 17:17). Simply put, the household builds a system of caring.

- We are grouped in a small number so that enough attention is given to each member, to effectively make him/her feel valued and cared for.
- As a household meets regularly and talks about the word of God, genuine trust and concern are slowly being established. In effect, the household members begin to open up for guidance, healing and complete transformation.

- i. The youth experiences a sense of belonging and acceptance.
 - ii. Through the system of caring, the household becomes God's expression of love to the members of MFC Youth thus becoming its most crucial part
 - As we care for the welfare of one another, each household member should be made aware of their responsibility to give loving correction when necessary, e.g. when a member shares that God is so good because he/she passed a quiz even without studying. Household servants should be sensitive to such errors.
 - It is important to note that the system of caring extends beyond the household meeting, and that accountability to one another is strengthened through this.
3. A Venue to Love – The household gives opportunities for everyone to learn the basics of loving as instructed and shown by Jesus Christ (cf. Matthew 22:39)
- In many situations, they are given opportunities to care and show concern to others, e.g. when one feels down or has done something wrong.
 - Everyone learns to desire good things for their group mates, e.g. when a member celebrates his/her birthday.
 - Everybody learns to share the happiness of others, e.g. when one gets good grades in school.

III. Conclusion

They devoted themselves to the teaching of the apostles and to the communal life, to the breaking of the bread and to the prayers. (Acts 2:42)

The household is the basic unit of MFC Youth. This is a very important venue where MFC Youth members and household servants alike grow in spirituality through God's words and prayers, and by the culture of sharing, fellowship, caring and above all, loving. Since the growth of MFC Youth



members start in the household, it is highly important that all MFC Youth households embody the 3 H's: happy (emotional), healthy (physical), and holy (spiritual). The core of the household rests on genuine love for each member and dependence on God's care and providence for him/her and for the group.

Session 2: Heart of a Household Servant

Rationale

The household servants serve as the older brothers or sisters of the members, thus, they carry with them a big responsibility. They are called to be role models, helping and supporting their members to grow socially, mentally, emotionally and spiritually. To do all of these, it is important for household servants to know and understand their proper attitudes, characteristics and duties.

Specific Objectives

At the end of the session, the participants are expected to:

1. Learn who a servant is
2. Embody the characteristics of a household servant
3. Respond duly to the duties of a household servant

Speaker's Profile

A brother or sister who has been a household servant for at least two years and who possesses the characteristics of an ideal household servant

Methodology

- | | |
|------------------|------------|
| ▪ Talk Proper | 45 Minutes |
| ▪ Closing Prayer | 05 minutes |

Expanded Outline

I. Introduction

Upon realizing how important the household is, we are now being called to become role models in our ministry. As household servants, we understand that the nature of leadership is the way Christ meant it to be – servant leadership.

II. The Household Leader

As we perform a vital role in our community, let us be mindful of the roles and characteristics that we should take.

A. Characteristics of a Household Servant

1. **Christ-Centered** – being centered on Christ means being deeply rooted in Him.
 - a. Prayer – Have a constant personal time with God. Be consistent in your prayer time.
 - b. Holy Bible – Be knowledgeable about the Scriptures. Read the Holy Bible every day; have a copy of “The Catholic Daily Bible Reading Guide” or any daily devotional will help you understand the word of God.
2. **Humility** – God exalts humility. True humility was shown to us by Christ when He washed the feet of His disciples (cf. John 13:1-20). He is the Master, yet He submitted Himself to them.
 - a. Humility is being ready to get our hands dirty – to do something that we have never done before, e.g. setting up and cleaning up during and after household meetings and assemblies.
 - b. Humility is being teachable – being open to how we can better lead our household group.
 - i. Listen to your leaders and learn from them, e.g., household servant, couple coordinator, chapter servant.
 - ii. Be open to receiving corrections and suggestions.
 - c. Humility is accepting our calling to be apostles of Christ. We follow His footsteps and live out His teachings.
 - d. Obedience comes from humility – There are three areas where we can exercise obedience:
 - i. Obedience to God – We are called to obey and follow His commandments simply because He is our God and we are His children.

- ii. Obedience to parents – We obey them simply because they are anointed by God to be our parents who will guide us all the way. More so, they know better than we do, and they know the things that are good for us.
 - iii. Obedience to our leaders and coordinators – Though we serve with them, God also anointed them to lead us, and we recognize their authority over us.
3. **Integrity** – We should show ourselves in all respects to be a model of good works (cf. Titus 2:7). A person has integrity if he/ she is:
- a. Honest – Be honest and sincere of heart in what you say and do and be men and women of your words, e.g. if we say that a certain thing is a sin, then we should not be doing it or even consider doing it in the first place.
 - b. Reliable – Be a man/ woman whom others can rely on, e.g. accomplishing the task given to you by your parents or Unit Servant.
 - c. Consistent – If we regularly meet and manage our household, expect that there would be consistency in the spiritual growth of the members, e.g. being on time for meetings will provide an example for members and also encourage consistency on their part.
4. **Excellence** – We do not just do something just for the sake of accomplishing it. We should do it with our best efforts. Always remember that we are doing it not for us, but for others and most especially, for God. They deserve nothing but the best from us.
5. **Love** – Remember that a household is a system of caring and our task as household servants is not just to lead a group, but to love them. We are God's expression of love for one another.
- a. Be concerned. – We need to have a personal concern for one another. Our relationship with our members should be like that of a family. Take time to call

your members. Persevere in gaining their friendship and trust. Be open and available to them.

- b. Pray for your members. – Thank God for blessing them and pray for their concerns.
- c. Make loving corrections. – We do not tolerate sinfulness. We instead try to understand the person involved and to confidently approach and correct our members. This will help them to grow in character (take note that this should be done in a private and loving manner).

B. Duties of a Household Servant

Note: The speaker may give some useful tips to the participants on how to accomplish these duties.

1. Sets and Conducts Household Meetings
 - a. The household servant schedules the household meeting twice a month.
 - b. He/she discerns topics for the household meetings.
 - c. He/she facilitates the group discussion during household meetings.
2. Always bring a bible with you most especially during household meetings
 - a. The bible is the source of God's messages to us. Through it, we are nourished and we are led to the things God wants us to do. Finally, the bible will be our weapon in pastoring our members.
3. Checks the pastoral formation of the members.
 - a. The household servant regularly monitors the talks/household topic that the members have attended and what they have missed.
 - b. He/she is responsible to look for a schedule when they can have a session for the missed talk/household topic.

4. Reports to his/her direct leaders (household servant reports to his/her unit servant; unit Servant reports to his/her chapter Servant & couple coordinator; so on and so forth).
 - a. He/ She should tell his/her leaders the present status of the group and the problems encountered in leading the household so that they can gain help and support from them.
5. Sets One-to-One Sessions (one-to-one's)
 - a. The One-to-One session is your personal time with your member. It is a private conversation between you and a member to establish a trusting and personal relationship with him/her. It is a time for you to express yourself and explore issues you would not normally be able to do in other circumstances. It is also an opportunity to discuss the concerns and personal problems of the member.
 - b. This can be conducted in a place where the household servant and member can have a comfortable and continuous conversation. (e.g. house, school grounds, church, restaurants or parks)
 - c. Take note that one-to-one sessions are done by gender basis. Brother to a brother, sister to a sister.

Note: Sometimes people have the impression that one-to-one sessions are times for correction. This “misconception” occurs when household servants are not able to conduct one-to-one sessions regularly and end up having to do so on occasions when members already have to be corrected immediately.

Guidelines in conducting one-to-one sessions

1. Prepare for it.
 - Pray for the one-to-one session.
 - Set the time, date and venue. It should be scheduled based on the availability of the member.
2. Start the session with a short prayer.

3. Allow the member to feel comfortable. Start the conversation by asking the member what he/ she had been doing for the past week.
4. Then gradually start with the one-to-ones proper. Ask the member some questions regarding his/her life. You may ask questions pertaining to the things that you want to know about him/her.
 - Make the conversation as relaxed as possible.
 - The technique is to balance the conversation. It is advisable to become a silent listener (one who does more of the listening than that of the talking).
5. Depending on the sharing of the member, you may have to allow the member to feel that God loves him/her, and that he/she is not alone in his/her problems. You may also have to empower the member by giving Bible verses or stories.
 - In cases that you need to make some advice, remember not to preach. Give it as a suggestion or friendly advice.
6. Before ending the session, ask the member if he/she has questions and prayer concerns.
7. End the one-to-ones with a prayer. Include in the prayer the concerns of your member.

III. Conclusion

We are called to do what has been commanded to us by God. We are called to take on these characteristics and duties to lead a small group of men and women, and to serve as living witnesses to the truth of God's love for them. This is a privilege for us to be counted worthy enough to lead a household. Even if it would be difficult at times, God promised us that He will never leave us in our service, and He continues to promise us spiritual maturity, healing and wholeness as we serve Him.

Workshop 1: Discerning a Household Topic

Rationale

After learning the basics of what a household is and the attitudes to take in being a household servant, the next step is to equip the household servant the skills he/she needs in preparing for a household meeting, one of which is discerning and making his/her own household topic.

Specific Objectives

At the end of this session, the participant is expected to:

1. Know the considerations in discerning for a household topic
2. Value the importance of prayer and discernment in choosing a topic for his/ her household
3. Create a household guide depending on the topic he/she has chosen

Speaker's Profile

A brother or sister who has been a household servant for at least two years and knows how to discern and create a household topic

Methodology

- | | |
|---------------|------------------|
| ▪ Talk proper | 20 to 45 minutes |
| ▪ Workshop | 30 minutes |

Expanded Outline

I. Introduction

The household is the basic unit of our community. It is through the household that God's love can be felt from the leaders down to the members. Therefore, it is important that our members receive the spiritual nourishment that they need through well-prepared household meetings.

II. Discerning for a Household Topic

For a household to be nourishing, the topic should answer a particular need of the members. Before coming up with a topic, a household servant should pray about it considering the following questions:

- A. What issue concerns your members right now?
 - Examples are time management, prioritizing their families, enduring in their studies
- B. What values do they need to learn? What values would prepare them for an upcoming event in their personal lives or community lives?
 - Examples are humility, compassion, hard work, faith, endurance
- C. What “themes” do your members need to immerse themselves into?
 - Examples are God’s love, God’s forgiveness and mercy, power of the Holy Spirit
- D. What is God telling you personally in your prayer time, Scripture reading, or Sunday readings?

III. Making Your Household Topic

After discerning and choosing the household topic, the next step is creating the discussion flow that will be used by your household. Every household topic has 5 parts:

- A. Goal** – The Goal part describes what the household wants to attain. It contains the objectives of a given household topic.
- B. Grab** – The Grab does not only catch the interest of your members, but it also introduces the topic in a creative way. It is a question with no right or wrong answers, but just asks the opinion of your members about a certain light topic. This can also come in a form of a short activity with the household servant processing it.
- C. Grace** – The Grace is the main body of the topic. It contains the idea that you want to impart to your members. It contains two (2) parts - the Bible verse and the supporting text (e.g. explanation, story, etc.). The Bible verse is important because our households should be Bible-based. It also teaches our members the importance of the Bible and encourages them to bring it in every household meeting.

D. Gather – The Gather part allows the participants to look to themselves and reflect how the topic is real or applicable in their lives.

E. Go Forth – The action part is the challenge where they can apply the lesson they have learned in the coming weeks. This challenge is monitored and checked by the household servant in the following household meeting.

Note: At this time the speaker can present the Household Jumpstart Manual to give examples to the steps mentioned above. He/she can explain that this is a tool that will help them conduct their first few households. After that, they should be able to make their own household topic based on the pattern given above. The Household Jumpstart Manual will be given to the attendees before the commitment ceremony.

IV. Workshop Proper

A. Requirements:

- Pen and notebook
- Household Guide/ Household Topic Blank Template (see Appendix)
- Bible
- Visual materials

B. Time Frame: 30 minutes

C. Process:

1. The speaker divides the participants into groups of 5.
2. The speaker then leads everyone into a short prayer and asks the participants to reflect on these questions:
 - What issue concerns your members right now? (e.g. time management, prioritizing their families, etc.)

- What values do they need to learn? (e.g. humility, compassion, hardware, faith, etc.) What values would prepare them for an upcoming event in their personal lives or community lives?
 - What “concepts” do your members need to immerse themselves into? (e.g. God’s love, God’s forgiveness and mercy, power of the Holy Spirit, etc.)
 - What is God telling you personally in your prayer time, Scripture reading, or Sunday readings?
3. Based from these questions, the participant chooses a topic that answers most, if not all, of the questions.
 4. The household guide/household topic blank template is distributed to the participants.
 5. The participants are asked to fill out the guide.
 6. If the schedule allows it, presentations per group can be done.

**Missionary Families of Christ – Youth
Committed Circle
Household Servants Training**



Workshop 2: Leading a Household Meeting

Rationale

The participants have learned and understood the importance of the household, the right attitudes and duties of a household servant and the basics of how to properly discern and make a household topic. Now, we shall teach them how to apply what they have learned in the next talk – What it Takes to be a Household Servant.

Specific Objectives

At the end of this session, the participant is expected to:

1. Know the practical “how to’s” and provide tips on how to lead a household;
2. Understand how a household meeting is conducted;
3. Understand the crucial role of being a household servant;
4. Learn useful ways of managing a household; and
5. Apply what they have learned through a mock household meeting activity.

Speaker’s Profile

A brother or sister who has been a household servant for at least two years and knows how to lead and manage a household group

Methodology

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| ▪ Talk Proper | 20-25 minutes |
| ▪ Workshop | 30 minutes |

Expanded Outline

I. Introduction

We have heard and realized that household meetings are a vital part of the lifestyle of each and every MFC Youth member. This is why our being a household servant is very important. We also

need to learn and to understand that part of our responsibility as a household servant is to lead and to manage our household group and meeting in the way God wants us to—as Jesus had shown us.

II. Preparing for your Household Meeting

The quality of preparation determines the quality of performance. Let's take it from Jesus Christ who gives importance to preparation. Before He teaches and performs miracles every day, He starts with a prayer (cf. Mark 1:35-39). So the very first thing to do is:

- A. Pray. Seek God's Word and guidance for the household meeting.
- B. Finalize the venue and time early.
 - 1. The day, date, time and venue of household meetings should be carefully discussed and considered earlier. It is highly recommended to follow the decided schedule regularly so that the members can block those specific dates and days.
 - 2. Consider the availability and schedule of each member. We do not want their parents or guardians to unnecessarily doubt the purpose of the household meetings.
 - 3. It is highly recommended that you change your venue in a house-to-house basis to give each member equal chance to host the household.
 - 4. Make the household a habit for your members.
- C. Inform the involved persons regarding the household (the chapter servant, chapter couple coordinator, the members of the household most especially).
- D. Prepare for your household topic. (This was discussed in the previous talk.)
 - 1. It is highly recommended that you print your topic and make copies of it that can be distributed to each member of your household.
 - 2. Read and study the format of the manual that you are going to use.
- E. Prepare for other things needed in your household meeting. (e.g. Bible, guitar, song lyrics, pen, paper, etc.)

III. Leading your Household Meeting

Now the question is: How are we going to lead our household group? What are the next steps? Let us take it from the Master, Jesus Christ, who led His apostles with love and good deeds!

- A. Be at the venue before your members.
- B. Make ready all the necessary materials needed, i.e. guitar, lyrics, Bible, copies of the household topic.
- C. Worship. If you do not have the opportunity or if the venue does not allow it, you may start it with a prayer.
- D. Distribute the copies of the household topic.
- E. Start the household proper. (Refer to the MFC Youth JUMPSTART manual.)
 - Follow the format of the household topic you are using.
- F. Household Sharing
 1. The manner of sharing should be “kamustahan” or “what has been happening to you this last week/ month?” but it should still be based on the guide questions of the topic to manage the discussion well.
 2. Do not forget to manage the time of each sharing. In cases of a long sharing, you may have to interfere by making a respectful gesture to the person to shorten or end his/ her sharing. Please take note that it must be done in a nice and loving way.
 3. For a first household meeting, it is very important to stress out that every sharing is confidential and should not be discussed with other people.
 4. The household servant must take note of important points brought up by their members through their sharing’s. (You may write it down to recall it easily during the processing.)

IV. Ending the Household Meeting

- A. After the sharing part, the household servant should summarize all the significant points brought up to bring up the challenge and make the message of the household topic concrete.
- B. Ask your members if they have any prayer intentions.
- C. Encourage and remind everyone to pray and support one other. Also, affirm them that you will also pray for them.

D. End the meeting with a closing prayer or worship.

V. Workshop – Mock Household Meeting

A. Requirements:

- Household topics created during the previous workshop
- Facilitators from the service team

B. Time Frame: 30 minutes

C. Process:

1. After the talk, divide the number of participants into groups of 3.
2. Each group member will be assigned the role of a sharer, listener and observer.
3. As the sharer shares about a certain topic, the listener tries to process the sharing.
4. After the sharing and the processing stage, the observer gives his/her comments on how the listener can improve more in leading a household.
5. The roles are interchanged until every person has performed the different roles.

Note: After this workshop, the service team will distribute the Household Jumpstart Manual to all the attendees of the Household Servants Training.

Workshop 3: Leading Worship Workshop

Rationale

Worship is a vital part of our relationship with the Lord. It is where we honor Him proudly and shout to the whole world how great God is. It also plays a major role in our community life. It is where, as brothers and sisters, we come together and praise the Lord as one body. It is therefore imperative for every MFC Youth servant to be able to lead worship.

Specific Objectives

At the end of this workshop, the participant will be able to:

1. Know the importance of worship;
2. Know the different parts of worship;
3. Have the skill to exhort people into worship; and
4. Have the courage to lead worship.

Methodology

- Talk Proper 30 minutes
- Exhortation workshop 30 minutes

Note: For this talk, the preferred speaker is a brother.

Expanded Outline

I. Introduction – The importance of Worship

“Worship” in the New Testament Greek means:

1. “**Latreuō**”, which means “to serve” (cf. Acts 24:14; Philippians 3:3; Revelations 7:15); and
2. “**Proskuneō**”, which means “to bow in respect or submission” (cf. Matthew 2:11; 4:9-10; John 4:20-24; Revelations 7:11).

These words are used to describe the proper expressions of honor and respect shown to a human king in ceremonial of royal courts and palaces. Worship is paying “homage” to our true King and Captain. In the same way that subjects in ancient times have to regularly visit their ruler and pay “tribute”, “homage”, or “tax” in more modern terms, we come to pay homage admitting that everything we have is God’s. At the same time, we are grateful that He gives all of these—our bodies, our minds, our money, our property—for us to freely use, and that He never punishes us as we deserve whenever we misuse these things that are rightfully His.

Worship is one of the very few times when we are able to have a taste of how it was and a foretaste of how it will. It is the time when we, in our fallen, sinful, human nature, are able to connect with God in spirit in the way it was meant to be before our sin made it impossible for us to continually be in God’s presence, as Adam and Eve were.

Worship allows us a foretaste of the kind of relationship we will have with God when we are made perfect in heaven.

II. Parts of Worship

- Exhortation
- Sign of the Cross
- Spontaneous praising
- Praising song (2 fast songs)
- Spontaneous Praising
- Worship Song (either 1 or 2 slow songs)
- Singing in the Spirit
- Prophecy/ speaking God’s word
- Praising and thanking God (Thanksgiving)
- Lifting-up of concerns (Supplication)
- Closing Prayers (Our Father, Hail Mary, Glory be.)

III. How to give an exhortation

Exhortation is giving people reason to worship. It should be able to inspire them to come before the Lord in jubilant praise. It can either be a personal sharing, a story, or a bible verse. An exhortation need not be long but should be encouraging and it must acknowledge God's greatness in our lives.

- Exhorting people before the worship. It must be within 3 to 5 minutes.
- Sharing an inspiring story from the Bible or a personal experience.
- Encouraging people to be in the right posture:
 - ✓ To honor God
 - ✓ To listen to Him
 - ✓ To worship Him

IV. Leading worship is a privilege

We should always remember that it is by God's grace that we are able to worship Him.

For the brothers:

As brothers in the community, we are tasked to lead the worship. We do this because we believe that the men should lead their families closer to God. So, young as we are, we are now being trained to lead our brothers and sisters to worship so that when we have our own families, we can lead them as well.

For the sisters:

For the sisters, we too can lead worship when we are in an all sisters' household or assembly. However, when it is a joint activity we let the brothers lead.

Leading worship is a privilege because we become closer to Him if we do this. We are able to come into His presence and experience "Glory". Therefore, it is a greater privilege to be able to lead God's people to worship.

Given that worship is a privilege, what are attitudes we have to keep in mind as worship leaders? We have to be:

1. **Humble.** We should never forget that it is not because of our talents and abilities that we are able to lead worship. It is because God chose us and it is by His grace alone that we can lead.
2. **Open.** Even if we already have a set of songs, we should be always be open to the leading of the spirit
3. **Prayerful.** We should be able to connect to God first before leading His people into worship. Even Jesus always connected to His Father.

V. Our Attitudes Regarding Worship

A. Worship should always start with an exhortation.

Exhortation is giving people reason to worship. It should be able to inspire them to come before the Lord in jubilant praise. It can either be a personal sharing, an inspiring story, or a bible verse. An exhortation need not be long but should be encouraging and acknowledges God's greatness in our lives.

B. You need to worship from the heart.

Avoid just singing songs. Enter into God's Holy presence, raise your hands and mean it. Pray in tongues. Listen to God.

Do not be too conscious of the words you will use, just speak exactly what is in your heart. Talk to the Lord as if He were in front of you, because He is. Avoid making your prayer a "well-rehearsed speech" with words "Lord" at the beginning and "Amen" at the end.

C. Worship is an expression of your life

Worship is very important, but is only an expression of the even more important reality you are living. Be careful in saying words like "Lord Jesus We Enthroned You" or "Refiners fire,

my heart's one desire is to be holy" if it's not true in your life, if you do only what you want in your life – in other words – you are calling the shots.

Worship, especially leading worship, is difficult if there is serious unrighteousness in your life, like premarital sex, cheating, gambling, stealing, etc. This doesn't mean that you should choose not to worship or decline from leading worship, since after all, none of us are worthy because all of us are sinful. Rather, it is in always having a genuine repentant attitude. Coming before God's presence and humbly asking for His mercy.

D. Be Real and Honest.

Come before God in total humility. Surrender and allow God's spirit to flow through you. Never fake it.

E. Be knowledgeable.

Know the songs by heart. Know their meaning, the right tune and know how to lead people into singing in the spirit.

F. Avoid anything that distracts

Avoid anything that distracts you or the people you are leading from focusing on God.

VI. Conclusion

When we worship, our lives are never the same again, so let us not fear the opportunity to lead God's people to worship.

VII. Activity

1. Make the participants think of a short exhortation, whether a latest happening in their life where God manifested His greatness or a reflection from a bible verse or a book that they have read.
2. Ask 3-4 volunteers to share their exhortation in front. The speaker can be the “critic” of the sharers.
3. End the activity with the worship.

VIII. Additional Materials: Music Ministry

A. Building up the music ministry.

- Prayer. It's very important to pray together. Pray for one another and pray for those you serve.
- Before each practice, have some 30 minutes of worship where the team can discern and try out new combination of songs and be able to consecrate the music ministry to the Lord.
- The team can have regular retreats, teachings, bible studies, and rehearsal camps.

B. Practice

- Regular practices are essential, like twice a month for four hours per practice.
- Regularly and frequently practice your part on you own.
- Review old songs and learn new songs.
- Clarify and practice introductions and endings.
- Teach proper music ministry orientation and ideal qualities of a music ministry member.

C. Playing

- Be punctual.
- Be attentive - avoid pocket discussion.
- Worship the Lord with your music.
- Be alert and always be ready to start a selected song.

D. Practical Suggestions

- Learn from the music ministry of other chapters
- Ask the help of other music ministry servants.
- Develop your own music composition.
- Spend time together in fellowship.
- Evaluate your music ministry needs and status of members regularly.
- Be open with one another for correction and encouragement.
- Do not let resentments stay among the group.
- Let God form your character and your talents and gifts for the music ministry.

PRAISEFEST EXHORTATION

Note: This activity is to be given by the team leader.

Read: John 6:1-14, Jesus feeds the five thousand

Just like the boy in the story who gave his “small” share of 2 fishes and five loaves, we are also asked to give a little of our time, effort and love. With the small offering that the boy gave, five thousand people were fed; and with the small sacrifices that we will make in taking care of our members, a big change will happen in their lives. They might be the next leaders of our community. Let us just do our part and God will amplify it.

We have committed our lives to Christ during our camps. Now we are called to commit to the mission in bringing everyone back to Him by being a household servant.

Note: At this time, the team leader leads everyone into a reflection while a reflection song is sung. After the reflection song, he asks everyone who wants to commit as a household servant to stand up. He asks everyone who committed to recite the commitment and say the Household Servants’ prayer afterwards. The activity culminates with a praisefest.

COMMITMENT CEREMONY: COMMITMENT OF A HOUSEHOLD LEADER

1. **I will care for my household members** by communicating with them regularly, informing them of all MFC Youth activities, and by making their concerns my own.
2. **I will bring my household members to the Lord** by teaching them how to apply Christ's words in their personal lives – their family, friends, schooling and love life, and in praying for them always.
3. **I will teach my household members to love** – their fellow household members, their brothers and sisters in MFC Youth, their family and friends and all the people around them.
4. **I will attend all activities of MFC Youth** – especially leadership trainings and the regular household leaders training.
5. **I will be a witness of Jesus Christ** – by being pure and righteous, being faithful to my studies, and being loyal to my brothers and sisters in MFC Youth and to my family, especially to my parents.

The Household Leaders Prayer

*Before I formed you in the womb I knew you. Before you were born I dedicated you,
a prophet to the nations I appointed you. (Jeremiah 1:5)*

Lord Jesus, I thank You for choosing me to serve You by caring for Your people. You know me, my guilt, my sin and my pain. I realize that I am most unworthy, yet You call for me, and so I ask for Your grace. Forgive my sinfulness and my stubbornness. Take my heart of stone and turn it into flesh. Teach me to love. When I lack patience, genuine concern and courage, let Your love and strength bridge the gap. Let me love with Your Love and Wisdom, and bless those I will care for that they may love. Fill me, teach me, guide me and give me strength. AMEN.

Appendix I.



<i>This must be accomplished after every Household.</i> <i>This shall be submitted to the Chapter Youth Servant.</i>	
DATE	
TIME	
VENUE	
NAME OF UNIT/HH SERVANT	
NAME OF UNIT/ CHAPTER COORDINATOR	
HOUSEHOLD TOPIC	
ATTENDEES	1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9.
REMARKS	

Name and Signature
MFC Youth Servant

Name and Signature
Couple Coordinator

Appendix II.



MFC Youth | Household Topic – Month of _____

Title:

Goal:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Grab:

Activity/Question:

Grace:

Bible Verse: _____

Message:

Gather

Reflection Questions:

Go Forth

Activity/Challenge: